

display dates and times. You can change this by selecting the cells and then right-clicking on them, and clicking Format Cells. A wide range of choices is available for every type of number.

A Mouse-free Experience

Moving a mouse to the different menus and toolbars very often during your work can be a little inefficient at times. The easy-to-use shortcuts are highly recommended. One does not have to remember three key combinations to do a particular task. All the shortcuts are displayed on the ribbons.



Shortcuts to features in the Ribbon

Pressing [Alt] + [R], for example, will show you the Review Ribbon along with the additional keys for each of the tools on it. So pressing [C] now will create a new comment.

You can also be using a particular Ribbon, and pressing [Alt] will show up the shortcuts for that Ribbon. Once you get used to this technique and slowly start remembering the keys it can save a lot of time.

Move Cells Around

Moving a certain cell around would mean cutting and pasting the value onto another cell. Another way one can move chosen cells around is by moving the mouse pointer over the border of a particular cell till it becomes an arrow. Then move the cell to the chosen destination and let go of the left-click.

Resize Scrollbars?

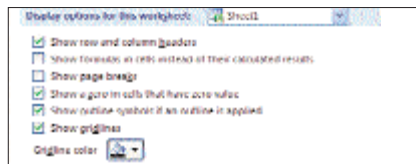
When there is only a single worksheet to work on, the extra tools meant for navigating between worksheets become useless. This space can be made useful by clicking the edge of the horizontal toolbar and then dragging it.

Show All Formulas

Normally, viewing the formula used in a cell includes clicking on each and every cell. Instead of doing this, a view for looking at all the formulas on the worksheet at one glance can be enabled by clicking on the Formula ribbon and then on Show Formulas. All the formulas in each cell on the worksheet are immediately displayed.

The Same Old Gridlines

Gridlines is probably what most Excel users are staring at most of the



The option to change gridline colours

time. Try some other colours for the gridlines to lighten things up a bit. In Excel 2007, you can change the colours by clicking the Office button and then on Excel options. Click on Advanced and then scroll down till you come across Gridline Colors.

The New Tools View

If you find that many of your toolbars and options are missing, they are most probably hidden away. Each of the toolbars only appears when the related type of action is done. For example, if you select a graph, the Ribbons such as Design, Layout, Format, and Analyze appear.

Multi-sheet Working

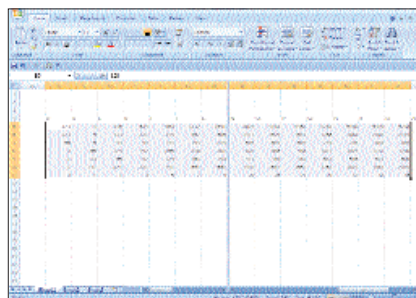
Multiple worksheets can be allowed to receive the same data being added to a particular sheet. Press [Ctrl] and go on left-clicking on the worksheets that you want to add data to. Then enter the text or numbers you want to replicate onto all the sheets.

Saving Paths For Images

While inserting images for headers and footers, it's important to save the paths for header and footer images. To do this, click on the Page Layout Ribbon. Click on the arrow at the right bottom of the Page Setup section. Click on the Header/Footer tab and then on Custom Header OR Custom Footer. Here you can manually enter the path of the image—which might be on a network, for example.

Divide Worksheet Space

Worksheets are bound to get very large, and navigating through one can get hectic. The best way to reduce the large amount of scrolling required to move from one corner of the table to another is to split the worksheet. It



Creating virtual partitions helps in navigation

makes a window, so to speak, which lets you view one area of the worksheet while you use the main region as well. To do this, look for a tab at the right bottom of the screen where the two scrollbars meet, click on it, and drag it. The newly-created division can also be disabled by clicking on the divider and moving it to the extreme end of the screen.

Selecting A Certain Type Of Data

To quickly select a type of data in a spreadsheet, press [F5], which is the shortcut for Go To. Choose Special and choose the type of data you want selected. Excel will automatically highlight that data type.

Tracking Changes

If you're working on an important spreadsheet and are not sure whether the changes you're about to make are the right ones, the Track Changes feature will alert you of the cells on which any modifications were done. To enable Track Changes in Excel 2007, click on the Review Ribbon and then click Track Changes.

Once the changes are done, you can move the mouse over the now-highlighted cells and a pop-up shows the original and the current value of the cell.

Copying Elements To Other Office Applications

Very often, one might need to move, say, a spreadsheet table or a graph to another Office application such as Word or PowerPoint. These applications work well hand-in-hand, so like you would normally copy and paste text within Windows applications, you can select a image or table, press [Ctrl] + [C] to copy and then [Ctrl] + [V] in the other program.

Quickly Select

When doing loads of work with several sets of smaller tables, the easiest way to select a table is click the cell at one corner of the table, then press [Shift], and then click the other corner of the table.

Merge And Center

Excel's new Merge and Center feature lets you align and format text with ease. You first enter your text, such as your heading or name of the columns, and then select these cells. Simply go to the Home Ribbon and click Merge and Center under the Alignment section.

Pivot Tables

Pivot tables are a way to easily access information entered into vast